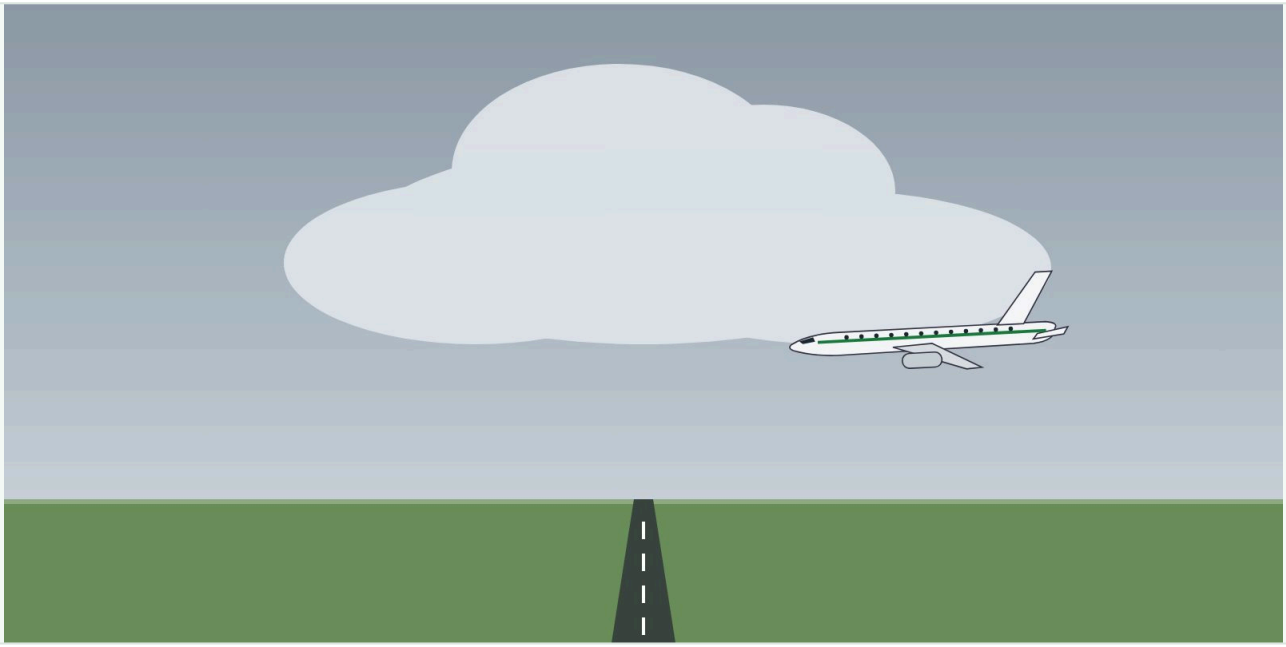
MODULE 1 · APPROACH OPERATIONS

Lesson 01: Classification of Instrument Approach Operations

Lesson 1 of 4 · about 7 min

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- Classify instrument approach operations as 2D or 3D, Type A or Type B.
- State the CAT I, CAT II and CAT III criteria.
- Identify which operations need a specific approval.



Type A or Type B — know what you are flying.

2D and 3D

- **2D** operation — lateral guidance only (e.g. VOR, NDB, LOC, LNAV, LP), flown to an **MDA/H**, using the CDFA technique.
- **3D** operation — lateral and vertical guidance (e.g. ILS, GLS, LNAV/VNAV, LPV), flown to a **DA/H**.

Type A and Type B (ICAO Annex 6, adopted by EASA)

Type	Minimum height	Category	Criteria
Type A	MDH or DH at or above 250 ft	—	Non-precision and some 3D approaches with higher minima

Type B	DH below 250 ft	CAT I	DH not lower than 200 ft, and visibility not less than 800 m or RVR not less than 550 m
		CAT II	DH lower than 200 ft but not lower than 100 ft, and RVR not less than 300 m
		CAT III	DH lower than 100 ft or no DH, and RVR less than 300 m or no RVR limitation

The former subdivisions CAT IIIA, IIIB and IIIC are no longer used: all are now **CAT III**. Operations below CAT I (CAT II, CAT III), and some operational credits, need a **specific approval** (EASA SPA.LVO).

COMPANY AUTHORISATION

The approach operations each fleet is authorised for — for example CAT I only, or CAT II for a fleet and crew with the approval — are listed in the **AOC operations specifications** issued by the **DACM**. The method and values for minima are in **OM A**; the aerodrome minima are in **OM C** and the charts.

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- 2D to MDA/H (CDFA); 3D to DA/H.
- Type A: 250 ft or above. Type B: below 250 ft — CAT I, II, III.
- CAT I: DH ≥ 200 ft, VIS ≥ 800 m or RVR ≥ 550 m.
- CAT II / III need a specific approval.

KNOWLEDGE CHECK

An ILS with a DH of 200 ft and RVR 550 m is classified as:

A. Type A

B. Type B, CAT I

C. Type B, CAT II

D. CAT III

Answer: B. DH 200 ft and RVR 550 m are the CAT I limits, which is a Type B operation.

Training material only. It does not replace the Aircraft Flight Manual, FCOM, QRH, MEL or the Domestic Airlines Operations Manual, which always take precedence.